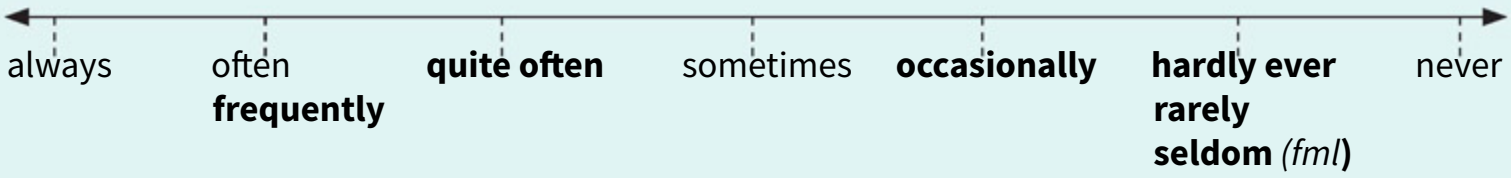
91 Adverbs

A Adverbs of frequency: how often



She **hardly ever** plays tennis now.
I **occasionally** go to the theatre.
We see them quite **frequently**.

I am **often** late.
He **rarely** works at weekends.
I have **never** been to America.

Language help

Remember that frequency adverbs usually go before the main verb, with the exception of the verb *be*. Notice the position of the adverb when the present perfect is used.

B Adverbs of degree: how much

I was **a bit** tired. (*infml*) The flat was **a little** (**bit**) small. She was **slightly** nervous.

Language help

A bit, a little and **slightly** have the same meaning and are mostly used before adjectives that express negative ideas, e.g. *We were **a bit bored**. I was **slightly upset***. (NOT *I was* ~~a bit happy~~.)
A bit and *a little* cannot be used with adjectives before a noun.
*It was a **slightly small flat***. (NOT It was ~~a bit small flat~~.)

The next four adverbs all mean 'more than *a bit* but less than very'.

The hotel was **quite** busy.
The food was **fairly** boring.
I was **rather** annoyed I missed the film.
The weather was **pretty** good. (*infml*)

We had **quite a** nice room. (NOT ~~a quite nice~~ room)
It was **a fairly** wet day.
It was **a rather** good party. OR **rather a** good party.
We had **a pretty** difficult journey.

The restaurant was **completely**/**totally** empty. I **totally**/**completely** agree with you.

We had an **extremely** interesting trip. [very interesting]
It's an **incredibly** good book.

C Adverbs of manner

These adverbs describe the way in which someone does something, or the way that something happens.

Nora had **secretly**[1] put all of the letters into her bag.

I went in and shut the door **quietly**. The curtains were closed and the room was dark, but I **suddenly**[2] realised I wasn't alone.

Penelope was in pain, and I could see she needed help **urgently**[3].

I spoke to Charles **briefly**[4] this morning. I asked him very **politely** if he could work an extra hour this evening, but he reacted quite **angrily** and walked off.

[1] in a way that others couldn't know about
[2] quickly
[3] very quickly because of something important
[4] for a short time

Exercises

91.1 **Form sentences from the words.**

1 get occasionally I early up — *I occasionally get up early.*
2 me ever phones she hardly
3 have leg my broken never I
4 frequently them I at visit weekends
5 brother often me Sunday calls quite on my
6 summer saw I him rarely the during
7 office always in she the is eight before

91.2 **Replace the underlined adverb with a different adverb that has a similar meaning.**

1 The film was <u>pretty</u> good. — *rather*
2 She <u>hardly ever</u> goes to conferences now.
3 The shops were <u>quite</u> busy.
4 They are two sisters, but they look <u>totally</u> different.
5 I thought the film was <u>a bit</u> disappointing, didn't you?
6 I'm afraid I'm <u>extremely</u> busy next week.
7 We <u>often</u> ask them to turn their music down.

91.3 **Put the two ideas into one sentence by using a suitable adverb.**

1 I walked up the path. I didn't make a noise. — *I walked up the path quietly.*
2 I must speak to her. It's important.
3 I asked him to move his car. I did it in a nice and correct way.
4 I spoke to her. I made sure the others didn't know.
5 He ran out of the room. It was very quick and unexpected.
6 I spoke to her this morning. It was only for a few minutes.

91.4 **Change the underlined adverbs in 1–4 to make them more positive. Change the underlined adverbs in 5–7 to make them less negative.**

1 The play was <u>quite</u> interesting. — *very*
2 I thought they were <u>very</u> good.
3 He's been getting <u>quite</u> good marks in his exams.
4 It's a <u>pretty</u> nice house.
5 John said the flat was <u>very</u> small.
6 They said it was <u>fairly</u> boring.
7 His clothes were <u>very</u> dirty.

91.5 Over to you

Make the sentences true for you by adding a suitable adverb, in the correct place.

1 I clean my teeth after breakfast. — *I always clean my teeth after breakfast.*
2 I buy clothes I don't like.
3 I lose things.
4 I forget things.
5 I remember my dreams.
6 I speak to strangers on buses and trains.
7 I give money to people in the street if they ask me.

Now think about each of your answers to the sentences above. Do you think they are:

a) fairly typical? **b)** slightly unusual? **c)** quite unusual?

If possible, compare your answers with someone else.

92 Time and sequence

A *When / As soon as*

The meaning of these two time expressions is almost the same, but **as soon as** suggests something more immediate or important.

I'll phone my uncle **when** / **as soon as** I get home.
As soon as / **When** you've finished this exercise, you can go home.

Common mistakes

I'll see you **when** I **get** there. (NOT I'll see you when I ~~will~~ get there.)
We don't use a future form after *when / as soon as*.

B Two things happening at the same time

Violet got ready **while** I cooked the dinner. [two long actions]
The accident happened **while** I was on my way to work. [a longer action 'on my way to work' and a short action 'the accident'; we can also use **when** or **as** here.]
I saw him (**just**) **as** I came out of the office. [two short actions happening at the same time; we can also use **when** here]

C One thing after another

We met the others in the café, and **then** / **after that** / **afterwards** we went to the match.
I talked to Joe, and **afterwards** [at a later time but usually the same day] I came home.
I was in Caracas for three months, and **then** / **after that** I went to Colombia.
After my visit to New York, I decided to have a rest.
We had something to eat **before** going out.

Common mistakes

After **seeing** the film, we went home.
(NOT After ~~see~~ the film, we went home.)

D A sequence* of actions

We had a really nice holiday. **First of all** / **First** we spent a few days in St Moritz. **After that** / **Then** we drove down the coast and stayed in Portofino for a week. **Finally**, we went back to Switzerland to stay with my uncle. (*Finally* is used here to introduce the last thing in a list.)

* one action after another, and so on

E *At first … eventually*

To begin with, the two girls got on very well when they shared the flat. But after **a while** [a period of time], they started arguing about various things, and **eventually** [finally, after a long time or a lot of problems] Lauren walked out and found a new place.

At first I enjoyed the classes, but after a while it got a bit boring, and **in the end** [finally, after a period of time or thought] I left.

F A list of reasons

We can use **firstly** / **for one thing** / **for a start** to introduce a first reason for something, and then **secondly**/**besides**/**anyway** to add a further reason.

A: What's wrong with her new dress?
B: **Firstly**, it's a horrible colour, and **secondly**, I don't think it suits her.

A: Why can't we go out tonight?
B: Well, **for one thing** / **for a start**, I've got a lot of work – and **besides**/**anyway**, I can't afford it.

Exercises

92.1 Find five more pairs of words/phrases that are similar in meaning.

~~then~~	for one thing	when	besides	finally	at first	for a start
in the end	~~after that~~	to begin with	as soon as	anyway		

then / after that ....

....

....

92.2 Choose the correct word to complete the sentences. Sometimes both are correct.

1 I rang my mum *when / while* I was waiting for my train.
2 I'll give them your message as soon as I *get / will get* there.
3 Maria cleaned the kitchen *as / while* I did the bathroom.
4 Before *leave / leaving* they went to an exhibition in a little gallery.
5 We can have lunch *when / as soon as* we've finished this.
6 The phone rang *while / just as* I was shutting the front door.
7 We spent the morning in the park and *after that / afterwards* we went home for lunch.
8 The letter arrived *while / just as* we were having lunch.
9 I met the others *when / as* I was on my way to the station.
10 After *to clean / cleaning* my room, I was exhausted.

92.3 Complete the dialogues.

1 A: Why do you want to stay in this evening, when we could go to Karl's party?
B: Well, *for one thing* ....., I'd like to watch a programme on TV, and ....., I don't think it'll be a very good party.

2 A: What did you do in Portugal?
B: Well, ... we flew to Lisbon and spent a few days there. ..... we took the train down to Lagos and spent a week on the Algarve with a couple we met in London. And ..... we went to Faro and flew back from there.

3 A: Did Matt enjoy his time in India?
B: Well, ... I think he found it difficult because the food and weather are so different. But after a ..... he got used to it, and didn't want to come home.

4 A: Why can't the company pay for me to go to the conference?
B: Well, ... the boss doesn't seem to think it's very important, and ..... we're too busy at the moment to give anyone time off work.

5 A: Did the new company do well?
B: Yeah, ... it did very well. But then the manager left, and after a ..... they started losing money. ....., they had to close down.

92.4 Complete the sentences in a suitable way.

1 We had a game of table tennis and afterwards *we went for a drink.*
2 I'll give you the answers to this exercise when .....
3 I'll text you as soon as .....
4 I must remember to lock the back door before .....
5 He thinks he dropped the letter as .....
6 I worked with a partner in class. I looked up half of the words while .....
7 We were in a traffic jam for hours but eventually .....
8 If we phone his home, he probably won't be there. Anyway, ...

93 Addition and contrast

A *As well (as), what's more, in addition (to), besides*

We often link ideas using *and*, e.g. The food's nice **and** very good value. There are other words and phrases we also use to add more information. Sometimes we still include *and* or *also*.

The restaurant has excellent food; it's **also** very good value.
You always get a good view, *and* the seats are comfortable **as well**. (*syn* **too**)
As well as getting cheaper tickets, I *also* got the opportunity to buy them in advance.
The clothes are nice, *and* **what's more**, the shop is open every day of the week.
The scheme gives young people experience. **In addition**, companies can afford to employ them.
In addition to the new food department, they're *also* planning to open a café.
Besides being a mum with four children, she's *also* a successful designer.

B *Although, despite, in spite of*

We use these link words when there are two ideas in a sentence, and the second is surprising or not expected. They can be used at the beginning or in the middle of the sentence.

Although / **Even though** the sun was shining, it wasn't very warm.
We found the place quite easily, **although** / **even though** we didn't know where it was.
They went for a walk **despite the fact that** it was raining.
Despite having no money, he **still** seemed very happy.
They got there on time **in spite of** the delay.
In spite of all the problems, we **still** enjoyed the trip.

Language help

We can use **still** to emphasise that we didn't expect something to happen or be true, e.g. *He didn't do any work but he **still** passed the exam; The work is very hard, but he **still** enjoys it.*

C *However, yet, though*

We can use **however** and **yet** when the second part of an idea is surprising after the first part. *However* is often used to link ideas in two separate sentences. **Though** can be used in a similar way in spoken English, but usually comes at the end of the sentence. Notice the use of commas (,) here, and the different positions of *however*.

I don't agree with a lot of his methods. **However**, he is a very good teacher.
We didn't particularly like the house. The garden, **however**, was wonderful.
It was warm and sunny when we were there. Most of the time, **however**, it's quite cold.

We went in the autumn, **yet** it was still quite warm.
I didn't like the film much. I'm glad I went to see it, **though**.
They told us the shop was next to the station. We never found it, **though**.

D *While* and *whereas*

We can use **while** and **whereas** to compare two different facts or situations.

Alex is very quick to understand, **whereas**/**while** the others are quite slow.
I get £20 an hour, **while** Josh only gets £12.
The speed limit on this road is 80kph, **whereas** it's 130kph on the motorway.
I was very keen on the film, **whereas** Christoph didn't like it at all.

Exercises

93.1 Put the words into the correct column.

~~in addition~~	although	in spite of	as well	however	also	what's more	despite

words that add more information	words that introduce surprising information
in addition	

93.2 Choose the correct word(s) to complete the sentences. Sometimes both are correct.

1 *Although* / *In spite of* we left late, we still got there in time.
2 She's going on holiday with friends. Her parents, *however* / *whereas*, are not very happy about it.
3 We decided to work *in spite of* / *despite* the fact we were on holiday.
4 They enjoyed the course, *even though* / *as well* it was very difficult.
5 I told John the car was too expensive. *However* / *Although*, he still bought it.
6 Most people tried to help us. They were very friendly *too* / *as well*.
7 Ethan spends his time in the library, *while* / *whereas* the others are always playing football.
8 It was a fantastic evening, *although* / *despite* the terrible food.

93.3 Combine parts from each column to form five short texts.

She went to school today	in spite of	she was never happy in the job.
She always worked hard in class,	although	she is very experienced.
She has the ability to do the job.	However,	the help I gave her.
She didn't pass the exam	whereas	she didn't feel very well.
She worked there for ten years.	What's more,	most of her classmates were lazy.

She went to school today although she didn't feel very well.

93.4 Complete the sentences.

1 People say the hotel is very good. It's *also* ..... quite cheap.
2 ..... the fact that they were busy, they ..... helped us.
3 It's not the best dictionary you can buy. ..... , it's better than nothing.
4 She managed to get there, ... she didn't have a map like the others.
5 ..... heavy rain, they've also had very strong winds.
6 She's the youngest in the group, and she's better than most of them ..... .
7 I think you can do it. It won't be easy, ...
8 I was right at the back at the concert, ... I could ..... hear everything.

93.5 Complete the sentences in a suitable way.

1 Although it's an old skirt, *I still like it. (OR it still looks nice.)*
2 My parents get up at 7.30, whereas .....
3 We enjoyed the holiday in spite of .....
4 If you buy a season ticket, you can travel as often as you like. What's more, ...
5 The exam was very difficult. However, ...
6 I understood what she was saying, although .....
7 My uncle is nearly 70, but he still .....

94 Reason, purpose, result, condition

A Reason

I went home early **because** I was feeling tired.
As/Since I was feeling tired, I went home early. (We don't usually start a sentence with *because*.)
I was feeling tired, **so** I went home early. (This is very common in spoken English.)
The reason I went home early **was that** I was feeling tired.

We can also use **because of** with a different construction. Compare:
They go there **because** the weather is wonderful. (because + noun + verb)
They go there **because of** the wonderful weather. (because of + (adjective) + noun)

Due to means the same as **because of**, and is often used to explain the reason for a problem.
The plane was late **due to** bad weather. (**Due to** is often used after the verb *be*.)

Common mistakes

It's a pity you can't go on holiday **because** Chiclayo is very nice. (NOT It's a pity you can't go on holiday ~~because of~~ Chiclayo is very nice.)
We moved house **because of** my father's work. (NOT We moved house ~~because~~ my father's work.)

B Purpose

A **purpose** is an intention or reason for doing something.
The **purpose of** the meeting is to plan next year's timetable. [the reason *for* the meeting]

We often introduce a purpose using **so** (**that**) or (**in order**) **to**:
I bought this book **so** (**that**) I **could** improve my English.
They went home early (**in order**) **to** watch the match on television.
We moved house **so** (**that**) we **could** send our children to this school.
She went into town (**in order**) **to** do some shopping.

C Result

These link words/phrases are used when one thing happens because another thing has happened. **Therefore** and **as a result** are more formal than **so**, and less common in spoken English.
I left my ticket at home, **so** I had to buy another one.
They've got more money, and **therefore** they can afford to buy the best football players.
I forgot to send the email. **As a result**, no one knew about the meeting.

D Conditions

We sometimes use **whether** [if] when we are not sure about something.
I didn't buy it because I wasn't sure **whether** you'd like it.
I spoke to the others, but I don't know **whether** they're coming.

We'll be late **unless** we leave now. [if we don't leave now]
Unless the weather improves [if the weather doesn't improve], we won't be able to go.

I have to go now, **otherwise** [because if I don't] I'll miss the last bus.
You'll have to turn up the music, **otherwise** [because if you don't] they won't be able to hear it.

You can borrow it **as long as** you bring it back by Thursday. [but you *must* bring it back]
You can wear what you like **as long as** you look quite smart. [but you *must* look quite smart]

I'm taking my umbrella **in case** it rains. [I'm doing A because B might happen later.]
Take some money **in case** you need to get a taxi.

Exercises

94.1 **Rewrite the sentences using *because of*. Make any necessary changes.**

1 I couldn't play because my arm was broken. *I couldn't play because of my broken arm.*
2 Teresa got the job because her exam results were good. .....
3 The weather was terrible, so we couldn't eat outside. .....
4 As she had a cold, she didn't go to school. .....
5 The light was bad, so the referee stopped the game. .....
6 The traffic was terrible; I was late. .....
7 He's only 17, and therefore he can't vote. .....

94.2 **Complete the sentences.**

1 I must write that letter now, *otherwise* I'll forget to do it.
2 I'll take some sandwiches with me ..... I get hungry.
3 We agreed to buy my daughter a dog ..... she takes it for a walk every day.
4 I left early ..... miss the rush-hour traffic.
5 My girlfriend didn't feel very well. ..... , we left the party quite early.
6 ..... there's a problem, I won't disturb you.
7 You can borrow my dictionary ..... you bring it back on Monday.
8 You'd better tidy your room, ... your mother will be angry.
9 I sent Luiza an invitation, but I don't know ..... she's coming.
10 The ..... I didn't ring you was that I'd lost your phone number.

94.3 **Complete the memo.**

Reply Forward

To All Staff CC BCC

From Daniel Myers 09 August

Subject Temporary roadworks

From next Monday, the council are closing both approach roads to the factory. The [1] *purpose* of this, I believe, is to install new gas pipes. [2] ..... this will create long delays, could I please ask staff to leave home a few minutes early in the morning [3] ..... everyone gets here on time. The roadworks also mean that you won't be able to park on the street, and [4] ..... it may be a good idea to leave your cars at home [5] ..... it is absolutely impossible for you to use public transport.

I haven't been told [6] ..... the roadworks will continue for the whole week, but I will let you know as soon as possible, and I apologise for the inconvenience.

Daniel Myers
Office manager

94.4 **Over to you**

Complete the sentences in a way that is true for you.

I want to improve my English because .....
I don't know whether my English .....
I often need to write words down, otherwise I .....
I don't get many opportunities to practise my English, therefore .....
Speaking English may be important in order to .....

95 Formal and informal English

A Formal English

Formal English is more common in writing, but you will also hear examples in more formal spoken English, e.g. announcements, speeches, television news, or discussions.

NOTICE IN A CAFE: Only food **purchased** [bought] here may be eaten **on the premises** [here].

BUSINESS LETTER: I **regret to inform you** [I am sorry to say] that we are unable to …

INFORMATION NOTICE: If you **require** [need] **further assistance** [more help], please contact the above address.

FORMAL LETTER: We are not in a position to **grant** [give or allow] you a visa to this country.

POLICE STATEMENT: The man is being questioned **regarding** [about] the robbery last night.

THEATRE ANNOUNCEMENT: The play will **commence** [start] in two minutes.

STATION ANNOUNCEMENT: The next train to **depart** [leave] from platform 7 will be the 7:22 to Reading.

AIRPORT ANNOUNCEMENT: Will passengers for Miami please **proceed to** [go to] gate 36.

B Informal English

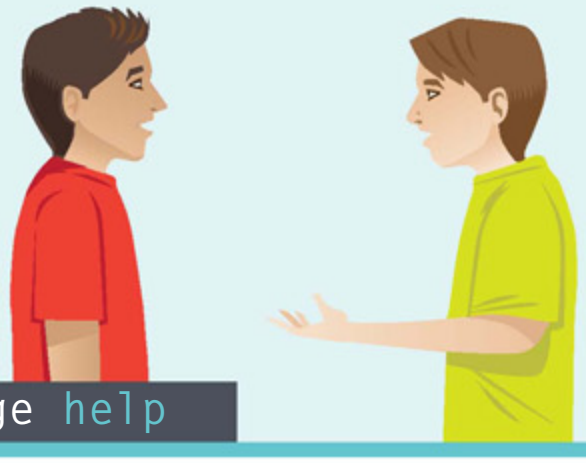
Informal language is more common in spoken English, and also in most emails or letters to friends. The words and phrases in **bold** in these dialogues are all informal.

A: Who's Callum?
B: A **mate** [a friend] of mine.
A: Really?
B: Yeah, I see him **quite a bit** [often]; he's a nice **bloke** [man].

A: Toby, I'm afraid I can't **make it** [come] this evening.
B: Oh, that's a shame.
A: Yeah, I'm sorry, but **the thing is** [the problem is], Ella's not well, so I'll have to look after the **kids** [children].
B: OK, don't worry. There will still be twelve **or so** [about twelve] at the meeting, and I'll ring you later and let you know what happens.
A: **Cheers** [thanks]. That would be great.

A: **I bet** [I'm sure] you're hungry.
B: Yes, **I'm dying for** something to eat. [want to eat something very much]
A: Well, I think you'll find some **stuff** in the fridge.

A: What **are** you **up to** this evening? [What are you doing?]
B: Nothing much. Why?
A: Well, would you like to see the new Coen Brothers film? I've heard it's **great** [very good; *syn* **terrific**].
B: Really? My brother saw it and said it was **a load of rubbish** [terrible].



Language help

We often use the uncountable noun **stuff**, especially in spoken English, to refer to an uncountable noun or a group of things. We do this when others know what we are talking about, or if we don't need to be exact.
Put this **stuff** in the cupboard. [e.g. plates, food, toys]
We carried our camping **stuff** [equipment].
What's this **stuff** in the fridge in the blue bottle? [liquid]

Exercises

95.1 **Put the words into the correct column on the right.**

~~depart~~	mate
cheers	commence
regarding	terrific
purchase	bloke
proceed to	kids

formal	informal
depart	

95.2 **Now write a synonym for each of the words in 95.1.**

depart	*leave*	mate	
cheers		commence	
regarding		terrific	
purchase		bloke	
proceed to		kids	

95.3 **Replace the underlined words and phrases with more informal words or phrases.**

1 I'm sure your parents are pleased? *I bet* .....
2 I'd love to come, but the problem is, my mother wants us to go and see her. .....
3 I watched that new series on TV last night. It was absolutely terrible. .....
4 What are you doing this weekend? .....
5 I really want something to drink. .....
6 None of them can come on Monday. .....
7 Jamie is a friend of mine. .....
8 We go there often. .....
9 You can leave all those books, files and papers on the desk. .....
10 We should be able to get approximately 40 on the coach. .....

95.4 **Rewrite the underlined parts of this letter in more suitable formal English.**

1 *regarding* .....
2 .....
.....
3 .....
4 .....
.....

Reply Forward

To M. Collins x 7:03 AM (3 hours ago)

Dear Mr Collins

We are writing about[1] your application to the council for a disabled parking space outside your home. We're sorry to say[2] that we are unable to allow[3] this request as parking is the sole responsibility of the Highways Agency.

We suggest that if you need more help[4], you should contact them on 01727 717 317.

95.5 **Dictionaries will tell you if a word is *formal* or *informal/spoken*. Use your dictionary to find out if the underlined words here are *formal* or *informal/spoken*. What do they mean?**

1 I thought the film was a drag.
2 Smoking isn't permitted.
3 It's a scary film.
4 This watch cost fifty quid.

96 Completing forms and CVs

A Types of form

- a **registration form** — where you enter your name on an official list, e.g. at a school or college (also called an **enrolment form** when you are applying to do a course of study)
- an **entry form** — if you want to enter for an exam, e.g. Cambridge English: First
- a **landing card** — for people from some countries when they enter the UK
- a **visa application form** — when you make an official request to enter or leave some countries

B Language of forms

When you **fill in** [complete] a form, you will see that they often have more formal expressions. In spoken English, ideas may be expressed differently.

written	spoken
date of birth	= When were you born?
place of birth	= Where were you born?
country of origin	= Where do you come from?
marital status	= Are you single or married?
date of arrival	= When did you arrive?
date of departure	= When are you leaving? OR When did you leave?
signed	= Write your **signature** [the special way you have of writing your own name]

C Curriculum vitae

If you **apply for** a job, you need to send a letter and a **CV** (**curriculum vitae** or **résumé** in American English), which should give:

- **personal details** [information about you such as your name, address, email address, etc.]
- details about your **education** and **qualifications**, e.g. university degree, teaching certificate, etc.
- your **work experience** [the jobs you have done]
- your **interests** [what you enjoy doing]
- **skills** [abilities you have learned and practised, e.g. ability to speak a foreign language]
- **career aims** [what you want to do in your future working life]
- names of people who will give you a **reference** [a letter written by someone who knows you which says if you are suitable for a particular job]

If you **apply to** university, they **require** [need; *fml*] a **personal statement** in which you must explain why you want to go to this university; why you want to follow this particular course; details of your educational background; your skills; your interests.

D Tips for writing a CV or personal statement

A **tip** is a useful piece of advice. Here are some tips for writing a CV or personal statement.

- A CV should be no longer than two pages; a personal statement no more than 45 lines of text.
- **Type** your CV or personal statement (**handwriting** is not suitable).
- Keep it simple. Don't make it **complicated** [difficult to understand].
- Check there are no mistakes.
- Make sure the information you give is **relevant** [connected to and useful for the particular job]. For example, if you are going to be working **on your own** [without others], don't say that you are good at working **in a team** [with a group of people].

Exercises

96.1 **What forms do you have to complete in these situations?**

1 You are just arriving in Britain and you come from a country outside the European Union. *A landing card*
2 You are applying to do an English course at a school in Britain. .....
3 You are going to do a Cambridge exam. .....
4 You want to travel to the United States this summer. .....

96.2 **Write these sentences in more informal English.**

1 What was your date of arrival? *When did you arrive/get here?*
2 What's your date of birth? .....
3 What's your country of origin? .....
4 What's your marital status? .....
5 What's your date of departure? .....

96.3 **Match the words on the left with the information on the right.**

1	personal details	*c*	a I would like to become a radio producer.
2	education		b Trainee at Northern Radio Station, Jan–June 2007
3	qualifications		c Leona Phillips, 18 Mansion Road, Beckington BE2 3RJ
4	work experience		d I direct plays for a theatre group, and help with a children's charity.
5	career aims		e letter from Mr J. Tobin BA, MA (University tutor)
6	interests		f BA Honours degree in Media Studies
7	references		g Kent University 2007–2010, Ainslie Grammar School 1999–2006

96.4 **Answer *correct* or *incorrect*.**

1 It's OK to make one or two mistakes in my CV. *incorrect*
2 I need to type my CV. .....
3 It's OK if my CV is three pages long. .....
4 My CV should be complicated. .....
5 For an admin job, it is relevant to say I have computer skills. .....
6 I can put down a driving licence as one of my skills. .....
7 I can put down travelling abroad as a career aim. .....

96.5 **Replace the underlined words with a word or phrase that has a similar meaning.**

1 Do I have to <u>complete</u> this form? *fill in*
2 Monica gave me a useful <u>piece of advice</u> about shopping in America. .....
3 I shall be <u>alone</u> most of the time. .....
4 They sent the form back to me because I didn't <u>write my signature</u> at the bottom. .....
5 Please contact us if you <u>need</u> any more help. .....
6 I think I'm good at working as part of a <u>group of people</u>. .....

96.6 Over to you

Answer the questions. If possible, ask someone else the same questions.

1 Have you ever written a CV? If so, what information did it include?

2 Have you had to write a personal statement? If so, why?

3 On a CV, what would you put as your interests, your skills, and your career aims?

97 Writing an essay

A The basis of a discursive essay*

In a discursive essay you have to express your own ideas and **point of view** [opinion]. It is also important to show that you understand **both sides of an argument** [reasons **for** something and reasons **against** something]. This means you need to understand and use different link words and phrases such as **in addition, however,** etc. (See Unit 93.)

* an essay that discusses a subject

B Expressing a point of view

Some people believe [Some people think] that no one should be sent to prison under the age of 18.
There is **an argument** [a reason to think] that everyone should have a university education.

Language help

You can express a personal point of view with phrases such as **I believe** / **think that** … or **It seems to me that …** but you can also use less personal and direct ways of expressing a point of view, as in the phrases on the left. Many people think it is better not to use *In my opinion* in written essays.

C Giving both sides of an argument

One of the advantages of being an only child is that you have more attention from your parents. **However**, it can be lonely without the company of brothers and sisters.

On the one hand, computers can do so many things faster than human beings. **On the other** (**hand**), some people are becoming dependent on them, which is not a good thing.

D Comparing and contrasting*

We often **make comparisons** between groups of people, or between the past and the present.
Compared with / **to** my grandparents, I have had much more opportunity to travel abroad.
In the past people didn't have computers, **but nowadays** there is one in almost every home.
Most parts of the developed world have become richer in the last thirty years. **In contrast**, many countries in Africa have become much poorer.

* saying how two things are similar and how they are different

E Making generalisations

Sometimes a simple statement is not accurate, e.g. *Young people prefer to watch American films*.
This is not true for *all* young people, so we use certain words and phrases to show that we are **making a generalisation** [saying that something is true most of the time or in most situations].
In general, Japanese society is more focused on groups than individuals. (*syn* **on the whole**)
Teenagers **tend to** have [usually have] more freedom than in the past.

F Cause and effect*

Poor diet and lack of exercise are the main **causes of obesity** [reasons for being very fat].
Obesity is often the **result of** a bad diet and not enough exercise.
People don't eat the right food or get enough exercise, and **consequently** [because of this; *syn* **as a result**] they put on weight.
Poor diet can cause obesity, and this can have a bad **effect on** people's health.

* how something happens, and then makes something else happen

Language help

Don't confuse the verb **affect** and the noun **effect**.
*Pollution can **affect** people's breathing.*
*Pollution can **have an effect on** people's breathing.*

Exercises

97.1 **Match the definitions on the left with the examples on the right.**

1 expressing a point of view
2 making a comparison
3 describing the result of something
4 showing both sides of an argument
5 making a generalisation

- [c] a Canada has a smaller population than the USA.
- [ ] b People tend to retire at a later age.
- [ ] c Some people believe we should never go to war.
- [ ] d Animals die because we're cutting down the forest.
- [ ] e Television can make children lazy. However, there are many programmes with real educational value.

97.2 **One word is missing in each sentence. What is it, and where should it go?**

1 It seems me that there is a problem. *to*
2 One of the advantages studying law is that it should lead to a good career.
3 It is important to give sides of the argument.
4 Too much time spent in front of a television can have a bad eff ect children.
5 People like to have freedom of choice. On the other, too much choice can be a bad thing.
6 Time tends go faster as you get older.

97.3 **Choose the correct word to complete the sentences. Sometimes both are correct.**

1 There is not enough food, and *consequently* / *on the other hand* people are dying.
2 Advertising is so powerful that it *causes* / *affects* people to buy things they don't want. *In addition* / *However*, it can help them make the right choice when they buy things.
3 *In general* / *On the whole* people have more access to education than fift y years ago.
4 Supermarkets are very convenient because you can buy almost everything you want. On the other *side* / *hand*, they are putting small shops out of business.
5 The north of the country is much richer compared *with* / *to* the south.

97.4 **Complete part of this essay on the advantages and disadvantages of the Internet for children.**

One of the[1] *advantages* of the Internet is that children have access to so much knowledge and information.[2] ..... , many children can access this knowledge from their own homes; they don't have to go to libraries.[3] ..... , some of the information on the Internet is unreliable and out-of-date, and there are some websites we would not want our children to look at. [4] ..... , we need to control the way that our children use the Internet, and there is certainly an [5] ..... for much stricter controls on the websites that people are allowed to create. If we don't do this, the Internet could have a bad [6] ..... on children.

97.5 **Rewrite the sentences following the instructions in (brackets).**

1 People who drink and drive should go to prison. (*Show that this is a personal opinion.*)
I believe that people who drink and drive should go to prison.
2 People are conservative. (*Make this statement a generalisation.*)
.....
3 Cars should not be allowed in town centres. (*Make this opinion less personal.*)
.....
4 Children played on their bikes. Children spend most of their time in front of a computer. (*Make this a comparison between the past and the present in one sentence.*)
.....
5 Many people work longer and longer hours. They don't have time for hobbies. (*Show the connection between these two statements in one sentence.*)
.....

98 Formal letters and emails

A A formal letter

10 Baldwyn Gardens
Ealing
London W5 8PR
8 August

Dear **Sir or Madam**[1]

I am writing[2] **in response to**[3] your advertisement about job opportunities for **graduates**[4]**.** I have just completed a degree in Economics at Durham University, and **I would be grateful if you could**[5] send me further **details**[6] of the graduate training schemes you mention. I am **available**[7] for interview at any time.

I look forward to hearing from you.[8]

Yours faithfully[9]

Nicole Drew[10]

Nicole Drew

[1] use this beginning if you don't know the person's name
[2] This is a common way to start a letter.
[3] in reply to
[4] people with a university degree
[5] this is slightly more polite/formal than **Please could you** …
[6] information about something (plural noun)
[7] free
[8] This sentence is often used to close a letter when you expect a reply.
[9] Use this ending if you don't know the name of the person you are writing to. If you know the name, end the letter with **Yours sincerely**, or **Kind regards**.
[10] Writing your name like this in a particular way is a **signature**. It is normal at the end of a formal letter to **sign** your name first [write your signature], and then print it, e.g. Nicole Drew.

B Useful words and phrases

Thank you for your letter **regarding** [about] the damage to your vehicle.
I regret to inform you [I am sorry to say] that your **application** [official request for something] has not been successful.
I am pleased to inform you that your application has been successful**. [**I am happy to say**]**
I am writing to **enquire about** English courses at your school. [ask about]
You will need to **confirm** the booking **in writing** [write to say that the booking is certain].
We would like to **thank you for** offering your **support** [say thank you for offering your help].
We would like to **apologise for** [say sorry for] the **delay** [when something arrives later than expected]. OR **Please accept our apologies for** the delay.
I **enclose** a cheque for £100. [I am sending a cheque for £ 100 in the same envelope as this letter.]

Exercises

98.1 Correct seven more mistakes in the email.

Reply Forward

From Michael Ridley 7:03 AM (3 hours ago)

Dear ~~sir~~ Sir or Madame

I write with response to your advertisement for trainees in yesterday's newspaper, and I would be greatful if you could send me further detail.

I look forward to hear from you.

Kind regards,

Michael Ridley

98.2 Finish the sentences.

1 If you don't know the person you are writing to, you start *Dear Sir or Madam*
2 If you would like more information, you ask for further .....
3 A common way of closing a letter is *I look forward* .....
4 If you don't know the person you are writing to, you end *Yours* .....
5 If you know the name of the person, you can end *Yours* .....
6 Another way of ending a letter is *Kind* .....
7 At the end of the letter you also write your .....

98.3 Rewrite the phrases and sentences in more formal English, starting with the words given. Keep a similar meaning.

1 Thanks for the letter about the fire.	Thank you for your letter *regarding the fire.*
2 I'm sorry to tell you …	I .....
3 I'm happy to tell you …	I am .....
4 Are you free on Wednesday?	Are you .....
5 I want to ask about the dates of the course.	I would like to .....
6 We want to say sorry for the delay.	Please accept .....
7 Please send me the details.	I would be .....
8 Could you say that's definite in a letter?	Could you .....
9 I'm sending a copy of my CV.	I .....

98.4 Complete the letter.

[1] *Dear* ..... Mr Wilkinson,

I am [2] ..... in [3] ..... to your letter of 10 February [4] ..... the delivery of the Maxwell dining table and four chairs that you ordered.

In the middle of January there was a fire at the factory and it had to close down for almost a week. The recent heavy snow has caused further problems, and coming so soon after the busy Christmas period, we [5] ..... to inform you that there are [6] ..... of up to four weeks on most orders.

We promise to do everything we can to speed up deliveries, but in the meantime we would like to [7] ..... for the obvious inconvenience this has caused.

Yours [8] ..... ,

James Porter
Customer services manager

99 Informal emails and messages

A An email

[1] We can begin an informal email or letter with **Hi** Beth, **Hello** Beth, or **Dear** Beth.

[2] a funny person

[3] planning or intending to

[4] make contact, e.g. by phone, email or text

[5] want (to see) *infml*

[6] say hello to Conrad from me; also **send my regards to** Conrad. With family members and very close friends we also say **give** / **send my love to**.

[7] again, as before (here it is used to say thank you one more time)

[8] We can end an informal email/letter to a close friend or family member with **Love** or **Lots of love**. We also often use **Best wishes** or **All the best** when we end a letter or email to a friend.



B Messaging


Hi Emma
Sorry it's been **ages**[1] **since**[2] I last got in touch, but I just wanted to **let you know**[3] that I'm coming to Birmingham **in two weeks' time**[4] – **actually**[5] just before your birthday.


Sounds great, when exactly?


12 March. Could we get **together**[6] and go out for a meal? Maybe Mark could **join us**[7] as well?


That's perfect. Can you contact Mark and I'll book a restaurant?


Great! **Anyway**[8], better get back to work. See you soon!

[1] a long time
[2] from a time in the past until now
[3] tell you
[4] two weeks from now
[5] (see Language help)
[6] meet for a social reason
[7] come with us
[8] used to change the subject or end a conversation/letter

Language help

We can use **actually** to give more exact information, as in the letter (*syn* **in fact).** We also use it a great deal in spoken English to say something which is surprising or different from what you expect, e.g. He looks Italian, but **actually** he's not**. (***Syn* **in fact)** **Actually** does *not* mean *at the moment***,** e.g. *The land is* **currently** *for sale* (NOT The land is ~~actually~~ for sale).

Exercises

99.1 **Find five more phrases using words from the box.**

~~in~~	give	~~be~~	once	best	let	in	to	again	you
week's	~~touch~~	my	a	regards	time	wishes	know		

be in touch ....

....

....

99.2 **Write these phrases in different ways. The phrases can be similar but don't repeat exactly the same words.**

1 Hello Julie — *Hi* ..... Julie
2 Hello Mark — ..... Mark
3 Give my love to Patricia — ..... Patricia
4 Love, Evelyn — ....., Evelyn
5 Best wishes, Sam — ....., Sam

99.3 **Rewrite the sentences using the word in capitals. Keep a similar meaning.**

1 Do you want to come with us?	JOIN	Do you want to *join us?* .....
2 Do you want to go?	FANCY	Do you .....
3 I'll write soon.	TOUCH	I'll .....
4 It looks new, but actually it isn't.	FACT	It looks new, but .....
5 I'll tell you as soon as possible.	LET	I'll .....
6 I'm going three weeks from now.	IN	I'm going .....
7 Jamie is very funny.	LAUGH	Jamie is .....
8 Let's meet for lunch.	GET	Let's .....
9 I haven't written for ages.	SINCE	It's .....

99.4 **Complete the email with words from the box.**

~~touch~~	join	fact	together	hoping	in
let	since	give	ages	actually	anyway

Reply Forward

From Jonny M. x 4:42 AM (5 hours ago)

Dear Gilberto

I haven't been in [1] *touch* for [2] [ ] – I'm sorry about that. In [3] [ ], I've been really busy [4] [ ] I last wrote because I've got a new job in TV – [5] [ ] it's with the BBC. I'm doing research for various documentary programmes and I'm [6] [ ] to go to Brazil [7] [ ] three months' time. If so, I'll obviously get in touch. It would be great if we could get [8] [ ], and maybe Filipe could [9] [ ] us if he's free. [10] [ ], I'll write again soon. I hope things are going well with you, and [11] [ ] me know when the baby arrives. And, of course, [12] [ ] my love to Teresa.

All the best,
Jonny

100 Abbreviations

A Letters or words?



Most abbreviations are spoken as individual letters.

EU European Union
UN United Nations
PM Prime Minister
MP Member of Parliament
BBC British Broadcasting Corporation
ID identification, e.g. Do you have an ID card?
PC personal computer
CV curriculum vitae [a history of your job experience]
ISP Internet Service Provider

Occasionally abbreviations are spoken as words, e.g. **AIDS** /eɪdz/ and **PIN** /pɪn/ [personal identification number, especially used with a bank/credit card]

Language help

We use the verb **stand for** to ask about the meaning of an abbreviation.
A: **What does** EU **stand for**?
B: European Union.

B Written forms only

Some abbreviations are written forms only, but pronounced as full words.

Mr Scott (mister Scott)
Mrs Bryant (misses Bryant)
Dr Chapman (doctor Chapman)
St Mark's Church (Saint Mark's Church)
Dean **St** (Dean Street)

C Abbreviations as part of the language

Some abbreviations (from Latin) are used as part of the language.

Latin	abbreviation	pronunciation	meaning
et cetera	**etc.**	/et ˈsetərə/	**and so on**
exempli gratia	**e.g.**	/iːˈʤiː/	**for example**
id est	**i.e.**	/aɪˈiː/	**that's to say / in other words**

D Shortened words

Some common English words can be shortened, especially in spoken English. In some cases, the shorter form is more common and the full form sounds quite formal, e.g. refrigerator, influenza, gymnasium and veterinary surgeon.

phone (telephone)
maths (mathematics)
board (whiteboard/smartboard/blackboard)
case (suitcase)
ad/advert (advertisement)
gym (gymnasium)
bike (bicycle)
TV/telly (television)
paper (newspaper)
fridge (refrigerator)
exam (examination)
plane (aeroplane)
photo (photograph)
flu (influenza) [illness like a cold but more serious]
lab (laboratory) [special room where scientists work]
sales rep (sales representative; *syn* **salesperson**)
vet (veterinary surgeon)

Exercises

100.1 **Are these sentences correct or incorrect? If a sentence is incorrect, change it to make it correct.**

1 ISP stands for Internet Service Player. *Incorrect. It's Internet Service Provider.*
2 BBC stands for British Broadcasting Company. .....
3 MP stands for Minister of Parliament. .....
4 PC stands for personal computer. .....
5 UN stands for Unified Nations. .....
6 ID stands for identification. .....
7 CV stands for curricular vitae. .....

100.2 **What abbreviations in written English are often used for these words or phrases?**

1 Mister *Mr*
2 for example .....
3 and so on .....
4 Street .....
5 in other words .....
6 Saint .....
7 Doctor .....

100.3 **Rewrite this note, making it more informal by using short forms where possible.**

Luke

Olly had a ~~mathematics~~ maths examination this afternoon and then had to take his bicycle to the repair shop, so he'll probably be a bit late home. You can watch television while you're waiting for him, and please help yourself to anything in the refrigerator. If there's a problem — for example, if Doctor Brown rings about the influenza vaccination, my telephone number is next to the photographs on the dining room table. I should be home myself by about five.

Pam (Olly's mum)

100.4 **Complete the sentences with suitable words, shortened words or abbreviations.**

1 It was a warm day, so I put the milk and butter in the *fridge*.
2 He didn't want to walk, so he went on his .....
3 If you go to Mediterranean islands, ... Sardinia or Corsica, it's a good idea to hire a car.
4 If you want to apply for the job, you'll need to send your ..... with a letter of application.
5 The dog was sick, so we had to take her to the .....
6 In that shop on the corner you can get books, pens, writing paper, ...
7 I took my large bag with me on the plane, but I didn't have a .....
8 When I sold my CDs, I put an ..... in the paper and had three replies the same day.
9 If you use the cashpoint, remember you'll need your ..... number.
10 What does MP ..... for?
11 We did some experiments in the chemistry .....
12 My uncle is a sales .....

100.5 **Here are some more abbreviations. What does each one stand for, and where will you see them?**

PTO ..... RSVP ..... asap .....
IMO ..... DOB ..... PS .....